

# **SECOND TIMOTHY**

## **INTRODUCTORY MATERIAL**

### **Introduction**

Paul was imprisoned in a dungeon at Rome.<sup>1</sup> He was closing to his death when he wrote this second epistle to Timothy (4:6).

### **Author**

Paul is the author of this epistle (1:1).

### **Date of Writing**

The date of writing was approximately 67 AD.<sup>2</sup>

### **Historical Setting**

Under the reign of the cruel and unbalanced Nero, the Roman emperor (54-68 AD), Christianity became a illicit religion. Paul was arrested by his enemies using their Roman official position and was put into a Roman cell.<sup>3</sup>

### **Place of Writing**

Paul was a prisoner in a cold Roman cell,<sup>4</sup> regarded as a criminal (2:9).

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<sup>1</sup> A. Duane Litfin, "2 Timothy," in *The Bible Knowledge Commentary: An Exposition of the Scriptures*, ed. John F. Walvoord and Roy B. Zuck (Wheaton, IL: Victor Books, 1983), 749.

<sup>2</sup> Ibid.

<sup>3</sup> Bruce Wilkinson and Kenneth Boa, *Talk Thru the Bible* (Nashville: T. Nelson, 1983), 434.

<sup>4</sup> Ibid.

**Recipients**

The recipient of this personal epistle was Timothy (1:2).

**Occasion and Purpose**

The purpose of this epistle was as an encouragement to Timothy's ministry at Ephesus, asking him to stay faithful in hard times.<sup>5</sup>

**Genre(s)**

It is a Pauline epistle adopting the Greco-Roman letter format.

**Theme**

The purpose of this epistle is to charge Timothy to follow Paul, continue to endure suffering, and be faithful to God's word in hard times.

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<sup>5</sup> Litfin, "2 Timothy," 749.

## **ARGUMENT**

**The purpose of this epistle is to charge Timothy to follow Paul, continue to endure suffering, and be faithful to God's word in hard times.**

**Introduction:** Paul wrote this epistle when he was imprisoned in a Roman cell. He realized that he was approaching to his death (4:6), so this epistle could be his final reminder to Timothy his spiritual son, encouraging him to endure in hard times, and charging to stay faithful in the ministry of God's word. He, for multiple times, asked Timothy to go to him soon (4:9, 21).

**I. The salutation of this epistle is a greeting from Paul to his beloved son Timothy. (1:1-2)**

The epistle follows the Greco-Roman epistle format by starting with salutation. It clearly shows that the author is Paul (1:1), and the addressee is Timothy, followed by Paul's greeting with "Grace, mercy and peace from God the Father and Christ Jesus our Lord." (1:2)

**II. The thanksgiving of this epistle is giving thanks for Timothy's faith inherited from his grandmother and mother. (1:3-7)**

Paul then gave thanks to God about Timothy for how he had inherited his faith from his grandmother and mother (1:5). When he gave thanks, he said he always remembered Timothy in his prayers night and day (1:3), and was longing to see him. He rejoiced when he recalled Timothy's tears (1:4).

Thus, he reminded Timothy to kindle the gift of God (1:6), since God had given them a spirit of power, love and discipline (1:7).

**III. The charge that Paul asked Timothy for is to join with him in suffering unashamedly, faithfully, and depending on Christ. (1:8-2:13)**

**A. The charge that Paul asked Timothy for is to join with him in suffering for the gospel according to the power of God without being ashamed. (1:8-14)**

Paul then charged Timothy that not to be ashamed, but to join with him in suffering for the gospel according to the power of God (1:8). God has saved them not because of works but mere grace in Christ Jesus (1:9-10). Paul was appointed to be a preacher, an apostle and a teacher (1:11). Hence, Paul suffered without being ashamed, for he knew whom he had believed and Jesus would guard what he had entrusted to Him (1:12). Paul, therefore, asked Timothy to guard the standard of sound words that he had heard from Paul (1:13), and guard through the Holy Spirit who dwelled in them (1:14).

**B. The quality that Paul charged Timothy to have in suffering is he would not be ashamed, but be strong, faithful, and depending on Christ. (1:15-2:13)**

1. **The reason why Onesiphorus' services in Rome and Ephesus were told is to honor his willingness to suffer with Paul and being not ashamed. (1:15-18)**

Paul recalled the fact that all people who were in Asia had left him including Phygelus and Hermogenes (1:15). Onesiphorus, however, has been the one who was not ashamed of Paul's chains and searched for Paul in Rome and often refreshed him, as well as his services at Ephesus (1:16-18).

2. **The purpose of using images of a soldier, an athlete, and a farmer is to charge him to be strong and faithful, and suffer with Paul. (2:1-7)**

Because of the example of Onesiphorus, Paul encouraged Timothy to be strong in Christ Jesus (2:1). He charged him to entrust the things which he has learned from him to faithful men who will be able to teach others also (2:2). Then Paul suggested three images of suffering. First, he suggested suffering like a soldier of Christ Jesus for a soldier would not entangle himself in life affairs (2:3-4). Second, he used the image of an athlete for he would win the prize according to the rules (2:5). Third, he suggested a hard-working farmer should be the first one to receive his share of food (2:6). Paul, again, urged Timothy to consider the things that he said, depending on the understanding given by the Lord (2:7).

**3. The promise that Paul reminded Timothy is Christ has risen and we'd reign with Him if we endure because He is faithful. (2:8-13)**

Paul continued by asking Timothy to remember Jesus Christ has risen from the dead (2:8). He contrasted the his own imprisonment with the word of God which is not imprisoned (2:9). Because of that, he endured all things for the sake of the chosen ones in order to obtain the salvation in Christ Jesus (2:10). He quoted a trustworthy statement saying that Jesus will remain faithful for He cannot deny Himself. If we died with Him, we will also live with Him; and if we endure, we will also reign with Him (2:11-13).

**IV. The charge from Paul to Timothy is to pursue godliness, continue in correct teachings, and faithfully preach the word in hard times. (2:14-4:8)**

**A. The charge from Paul to Timothy is to pursue godliness to honor the Lord and charge the ungodly people who has gone astray from the truth. (2:14-26)**

**1. The problem of the people that Paul asked Timothy to charge are their ungodliness which have led them to go astray from the truth. (2:14-19)**

Paul asked Timothy to charge but to wrangle with some people (2:14). These people chattered worldly, emptily, and would lead to ungodliness.

Spreading like gangrene, the men who had gone astray from the truth about salvation, and they upset about other's faith. Among them there were Hymenaeus and Philetus (2:16-18). Therefore, Paul asked Timothy to be diligent to present himself approved to God as a workman handling the word of truth and he did not need to be ashamed (2:15). And God knew who belonged to Him, remembering the name who abstained from wickedness (2:19).

**2. The charge from Paul to Timothy is to ask him to pursue godliness with those who with a pure heart in order to honor the Lord. (2:20-26)**

Paul used an analogy of a large house. Within that house, there were vessels of different materials such as gold, silver, also wood and earthenware, and some to honor and some to dishonor (2:20). Thus, if anyone cleanses himself, he will be a vessel for honor (2:21). Then, Paul charged Timothy to flee from his youthful lusts and pursue righteousness, faith, love and peace with those who with a pure heart (2:22). On the other hand, Paul charged Timothy to refuse foolish and ignorant speculations, for the Lord's bond-servant must not be quarrelsome, but to be gentle to correct those who are in opposition and lead them God, so that God may grant them repentance, and they may know the truth and escape from the snare of the devil (2:23-26).

**B. The reminder from Paul to Timothy is to avoid the men opposing the truth, follow his persecutions, and continue in correct teachings in difficult times. (3:1-17)**

**1. The reminder from Paul to Timothy is to avoid the men who are superficially learning the truth but in fact opposing the truth in the difficult times. (3:1-9)**

Paul moved to a future perspective, for he said difficult times would come in the last days (3:1). He listed the wickedness of men and warned Timothy to avoid the men committing them (3:2-5). These men would enter into households and captivate weak women, follow their impulses, or learn but never come to the knowledge of the truth (3:6-7). Among them there were Jannes and Jambres, for they rejected the faith, and also displayed their folly to all (3:8-9).

**2. The charge from Paul to Timothy is asking Timothy to follow his persecutions and continue in correct teachings that he has learned in difficult times. (3:10-17)**

Paul charged Timothy to follow his teaching and other good qualities, as well as sufferings and persecutions just as what he had endured in the past, for God had rescued him (3:10-11). He highlighted that all who desire to live godly in Christ Jesus would be persecuted (3:12), while the evil men and impostors would proceed to worse (3:13). Paul charged



Timothy to continue in the things that he had learned and be convinced by them, which led to salvation through faith in Christ Jesus (3:14-15). Paul also affirmed that all Scripture is inspired by God and profitable for teaching and so on, so that the man of God might become adequate and equipped for every good work (3:16-17).

**C. The charge from Paul to Timothy is to faithfully preach the word against oppositions and endure the hardship for Paul is about to die. (4:1-8)**

**1. The charge from Paul to Timothy is to endure hardship and diligently preach the word in the face of oppositions. (4:1-5)**

Paul charged Timothy to preach the word in all time (4:1-2). He said that in the presence of God and of Christ Jesus (4:1). Preaching the word included reprove, rebuke, exhort, with great patience and instruction (4:2). In the difficult times, people would not endure sound doctrine, being stubborn, accumulating teachers in accordance to their own desires, and turning away from truth to myths (4:3-4). Therefore, Paul charged Timothy to be sober in all things, endure hardship, and do the work of an evangelist and fulfill his ministry (4:5).

**2. The reason of the charge is Paul was closing to his death and he is going to be rewarded for his faithfulness until the end. (4:6-8)**

Paul knew that his life was closing to death (4:6). And he had been

faithful throughout the journey and he would be rewarded by the Lord in the future (4:7-8).

**V. The remark is asking Timothy to go to Paul soon and bring him the things that he needed, remembering God's faithfulness in difficult times. (4:9-18)**

**A. The requests from Paul are asking Timothy to go to him soon with Mark, his cloak and the books since different people have left him. (4:9-15)**

Paul asked Timothy to go to him soon (4:9), and bring him Mark for he was useful to him for service (4:11). Paul also asked Timothy to bring the cloak and the books and parchments (4:13). Paul mentioned about some people who had left him for different reasons such as Demas, Crescens, Titus (4:10), Tychicus (4:12). Moreover, he mentioned how Alexander the coppersmith harmed him (4:14), he, therefore, asked Timothy to be on guard against Alexander (4:15).

**B. The remark made by Paul is the Lord has faithfully sustained him and powerfully rescued him from every evil deed. (4:16-18)**

Paul found no one support him or people even deserted him (4:16). However, the Lord stood with him and strengthened him, so that he could accomplish the proclamation and the Gentiles might hear to the gospel. The Lord had rescued him, and would rescue him from every evil deed until bring him safely to His

heavenly kingdom (4:17-18).

**VI. The closing greeting from Paul and his coworkers is regarding the coworkers of Timothy and to request him again to go to Paul soon. (4:19-22)**

Paul closed the epistle with greeting. He greeted Prisca and Aquila, and the household of Onesiphorus (4:19). He also greeted people beyond Ephesus like Erastus at Corinth and Trophimus at Miletus (4:20). Paul, again, asked Timothy to go to him before winter, with the greeting from Eubulus, Pudens, Linus, Claudia, and all the brethren (4:21). The epistle closed with a benediction (4:22).

**SIMPLE OUTLINE**  
**SECOND TIMOTHY**

Be Faithful

- I.** Salutation (1:1-2)
- II.** Thanksgiving (1:3-7)
- III.** Faithful in Suffering (1:8-2:13)
  - A. Charge (1:8-14)
  - B. Particulars (1:15-2:13)
    - 1. Example (1:15-18)
    - 2. Image (2:1-7)
    - 3. Promise (2:8-13)
- IV.** Faithful to Truth (2:14-4:8)
  - A. Godliness (2:14-26)
    - 1. Problem (2:14-19)
    - 2. Work to Honor (2:20-26)
  - B. Right Doctrine (3:1-17)
    - 1. Problem (3:1-9)
    - 2. Continue in Truth (3:10-17)
  - C. Preach the Word (4:1-8)
    - 1. Charge (4:1-5)
    - 2. Reason (4:6-8)
- V.** Remarks (4:9-18)
  - A. Requests (4:9-15)
  - B. God's Power (4:16-18)
- VI.** Greeting (4:19-22)

## **SENTENCE OUTLINE**

### **SECOND TIMOTHY**

The purpose of this epistle is to charge Timothy to follow Paul, continue to endure suffering, and be faithful to God's word in hard times.

- I.** The salutation of this epistle is a greeting from Paul to his beloved son Timothy.  
(1:1-2)
- II.** The thanksgiving of this epistle is giving thanks for Timothy's faith inherited from his grandmother and mother. (1:3-7)
- III.** The charge that Paul asked Timothy for is to join with him in suffering unashamedly, faithfully, and depending on Christ. (1:8-2:13)
  - A. The charge that Paul asked Timothy for is to join with him in suffering for the gospel according to the power of God without being ashamed. (1:8-14)
  - B. The quality that Paul charged Timothy to have in suffering is he would not be ashamed, but be strong and faithful, and depend on Christ. (1:15-2:13)
    - 1. The reason why Onesiphorus' services in Rome and Ephesus were told is to honor his willingness to suffer with Paul and being not ashamed. (1:15-18)
    - 2. The purpose of using images of a soldier, an athlete, and a farmer is to charge him to be strong and faithful, and suffer with Paul. (2:1-7)
    - 3. The promise that Paul reminded Timothy is Christ has risen and we'd reign with Him if we endure because He is faithful. (2:8-13)
- IV.** The charge from Paul to Timothy is to pursue godliness, continue in correct teachings, and faithfully preach the word in hard times. (2:14-4:8)
  - A. The charge from Paul to Timothy is to pursue godliness to honor the Lord and charge the ungodly people who has gone astray from the truth. (2:14-26)

1. The problem of the people that Paul asked Timothy to charge are their ungodliness which have led them to go astray from the truth. (2:14-19)
  2. The charge from Paul to Timothy is to ask him to pursue godliness with those who with a pure heart in order to honor the Lord. (2:20-26)
- B. The reminder from Paul to Timothy is to avoid the men opposing the truth, follow his persecutions, and continue in correct teachings in difficult times. (3:1-17)
1. The reminder from Paul to Timothy is to avoid the men who are superficially learning the truth but in fact opposing the truth in the difficult times. (3:1-9)
  2. The charge from Paul to Timothy is asking Timothy to follow his persecutions and continue in correct teachings that he has learned in difficult times. (3:10-17)
- C. The charge from Paul to Timothy is to faithfully preach the word against oppositions and endure the hardship for Paul is about to die. (4:1-8)
1. The charge from Paul to Timothy is to endure hardship and diligently preach the word in the face of oppositions. (4:1-5)
  2. The reason of the charge is Paul was closing to his death and he is going to be rewarded for his faithfulness until the end. (4:6-8)
- V. The remark is asking Timothy to go to Paul soon and bring him the things that he needed, remembering God's faithfulness in difficult times. (4:9-18)
- A. The requests from Paul are asking Timothy to go to him soon with Mark, his cloak and the books since different people have left him. (4:9-15)
- B. The remark made by Paul is the Lord has faithfully sustained him and powerfully rescued him from every evil deed. (4:16-18)

- VI.** The closing greeting from Paul and his coworkers is regarding the coworkers of Timothy and to request him again to go to Paul soon. (4:19-22)

**BOOK CHART**

**BE FAITHFUL**

|                  |                        |                       |                       |             |             |         |                   |                  |         |                      |         |               |                |         |               |
|------------------|------------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-------------|-------------|---------|-------------------|------------------|---------|----------------------|---------|---------------|----------------|---------|---------------|
|                  | <div>BE FAITHFUL</div> |                       |                       |             |             |         |                   |                  |         |                      |         |               |                |         |               |
|                  | Salu-<br>tation        | Thank<br>sgiv-<br>ing | Faithful in Suffering |             |             |         | Faithful to Truth |                  |         |                      |         |               | Remarks        |         | Greet-<br>ing |
|                  |                        |                       | Charge                | Particulars |             |         | Godliness         | Right Doctrine   |         | Preach the<br>Word   |         | Re-<br>quests | God's<br>Power |         |               |
|                  |                        |                       |                       | Example     | Image       | Promise | Problem           | Work to<br>Honor | Problem | Continue<br>in Truth | Charge  | Reason        |                |         |               |
| Topic            | 1:1-2                  | 1:3-7                 | 1:8-14                | 1:15-18     | 2:1-7       | 2:8-13  | 2:14-19           | 2:20-26          | 3:1-9   | 3:10-17              | 4:1-5   | 4:6-8         | 4:9-15         | 4:16-18 | 4:19-22       |
| Per-<br>spective | Past                   |                       |                       |             | Present     |         |                   |                  | Future  |                      |         |               |                |         |               |
| Tone             | Gratitude              |                       |                       |             | Encouraging |         |                   |                  | Concern |                      | Command |               |                |         |               |



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